Chapter 14

Taovu – The giant pandanus and the hood

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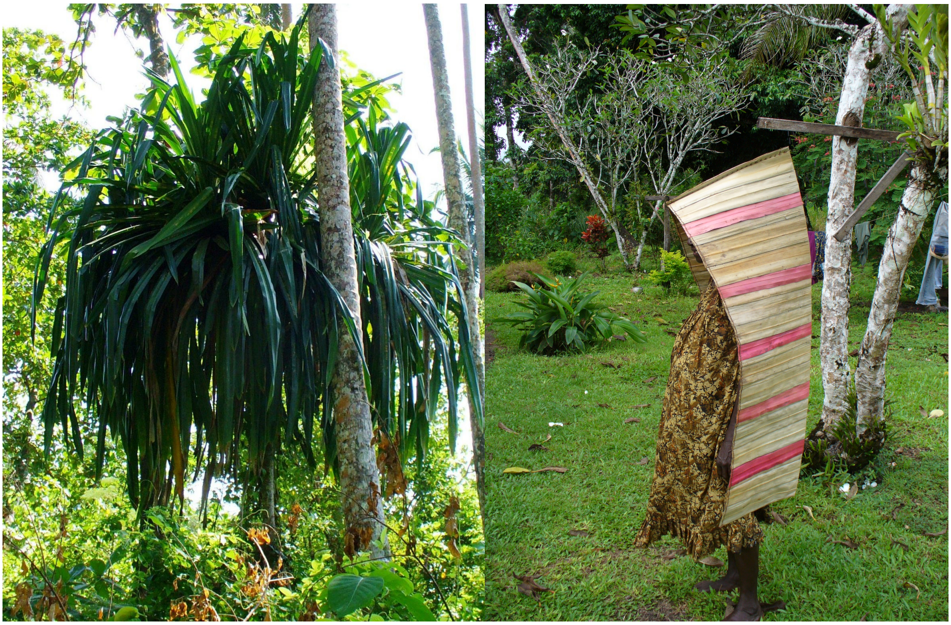

(a) (b)

Figure 1: (a) *Taovu* – Giant pandanus, (b) *Taovu* – hood

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(1)	***Taovu***	**The giant pandanus**
(2)	*O taovu na neba ni raara beve a rutaa.*	We plant the giant pandanus, when it is small.
(3)	*Rerau ore paa pura hiava komana bata maa.*	And then it grows up by itself.
(4)	*Be pura hiava, a paka nae repaa bebeahu bata maa,*	When it grows up, its leaves become long,
(5)	*ore paa taneo mee iku gunaha.*	so that they also start hanging down.
(6)	*Beo taovu pura hiava vaantee, ore paa vakavakarapi.*	When the giant pandanus has grown up to a certain point, it branches out in all directions.
(7)	*Bean rake ta mosi hape to peho peana, ean repaa mosi e.*	If you want to cut off a branch, then you cut it.
(8)	*Rerau ean paa kosi a paka no taovu meno taovu tean.*	And so you cut off the leaves of the giant pandanus for your hood.
(9)	*Bean kosi vakavara a paka taovu, ean paa kaakaru e bono pesupaava, bean varoava bata nom eve.*	After you have cut off the pandanus leaves, you scrape off the thorns with a coconut husk, when you put them in the sun.
(10)	*Bea paka taovu tean meapa, ean paa aha e bono kakaamuru.*	When your giant pandanus leaves are flexible, you scrub them with white sand.
(11)	*Ean repaa varoava vahabana e.*	Then you put them into the sun again.
(12)	*Bea paka taovu tean kakaavoo, ean paa taatagi e ore paa matatopo vo tea kuna bono taovu.*	When your giant pandanus leaves have turned white, you prepare them, so that they are ready for sewing the hood.
(13)	*O taovu na kuna riori bono sigauva roge, na matatopo varaba komana riori.*	They sew the hood with a thread made of hibiscus fibres that they have prepared themselves in advance.
(14)	*O taovu na uvuuvu ni riori teo vuri to siko nana a huan.*	They wear the hood, when the rain is pouring down.